

FAST-TRACK GRAD CHECKLIST

(CLICK EACH TO WATCH THE GRAD CHECKLIST TRAINING)

1

Do you have a winning research topic?

MAKE SURE YOU HAVE A WELL-DEFINED, FEASIBLE TOPIC THAT COVERS A MAJOR DEBATE WHICH YOU ARE PASSIONATE ABOUT

Your topic needs all these fundamental ingredients to help you get to the next-level. Too often grads struggle later on because the first important step of defining a winning topic never got put in place. Make sure your topic can be completed in the time you have, that you're passionate and excited about it and that it covers an important debate in your field. Then it's time to execute.

2

Do you have a clear roadmap to ensure you finish on time and stay on track?

CREATE YOUR ROADMAP

Set your timelines for finishing your paper or thesis, then reverse engineer the milestones along the way you need to reach them. Plan your next 2-3 months to optimise reaching one milestone so that you do not end up partially completing a few tasks.

3

Do you have a daily productivity planner to optimise you efficiency and keep focused?

GET ORGANIZED

Write out the main tasks that you need to complete for the day. Once finished, schedule out time blocks throughout your day for completing the action items listed below.

4

Do you have support, mentorship and feedback to stay on track?

MAKE SURE YOU HAVE ACCOUNTABILITY AND SUPPORT

You need to make sure you have steady support so that you stay on track. This could be from your supervisor, although they are not necessarily a good mentor. Consistent feedback is key so don't go too far in a wrong direction and risk losing time.

5

Have you mastered the fundamentals of academic writing?

THIS IS CRITICAL! TOO MANY STUDENTS WRITE WITHOUT EVER HAVING LEARNED THE BASICS

Dedicate time to learning the basics of academic writing. This will help you in you not only write faster and easier, but also communicate better with your supervisors, improve your results on the job market and help make it easier to publish.

****Click on any of the 5 points listed to watch a short training video on how to set up each one**

